

# Reverse Bits - Line by Line Explanation

ReverseBits Function Explanation (Simplified)

■ What does this function do?

It reverses the bits of a 32-bit integer. That means the leftmost bit becomes rightmost and vice versa.

Example:

If  $n = 5$ , its binary is 000...0101

Reversing gives  $\rightarrow$  1010...0000 (and that's a huge number).

■ Step-by-step breakdown

```
public static long ReverseBits(int n){
    long reverseNum = 0;
    for(int i = 0; i < 32; i++){
        reverseNum <<= 1;
        if((n & 1) == 1){
            reverseNum++;
        }
        n >>= 1;
    }
    return reverseNum;
}
```

Explanation:

1.  $\text{reverseNum} = 0 \rightarrow$  holds the reversed bits.
2. Loop 32 times  $\rightarrow$  because int has 32 bits in Java.
3.  $\text{reverseNum} <<= 1 \rightarrow$  shifts bits to left to make space.
4.  $\text{if}((n \& 1) == 1) \rightarrow$  checks if last bit of  $n$  is 1.
  - If yes, add 1 to reverseNum.
  - If no, do nothing.
5.  $n >>= 1 \rightarrow$  moves to next bit by shifting right.

This repeats for all bits, effectively reversing their order.

■ Example ( $n = 5$ )

$n =$  00000000 00000000 00000000 00000101

After reversal = 10100000 00000000 00000000 00000000

Decimal = 2684354560

■ Visualization

Original ( $n = 5$ ): 00000000 00000000 00000000 00000101

After reversal: 10100000 00000000 00000000 00000000

■ Simple Summary

We start with 0. For each of 32 bits, shift left, copy  $n$ 's last bit into result, then shift  $n$  right.

After 32 loops, bits are completely reversed.

■ Final Result:

$\text{ReverseBits}(5) = 2684354560$